

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

DVD Regions Conundrum

Q I have a Samsung DVD ROM attached to my P III that worked just fine. One day, I saw that it could not read the DVD disk, however, it read CDs till now. From the 'DVD Region' in the 'Properties' of the DVD-ROM drive, I found that the current region shows Region 1, but India belongs to Region 5. When I try to change the region from 1 to 5, I receive an error message: "Unable to update region setting. Please make sure the drive contains Region 5 media and you have administration privileges." How do I make my DVD drive read a DVD?

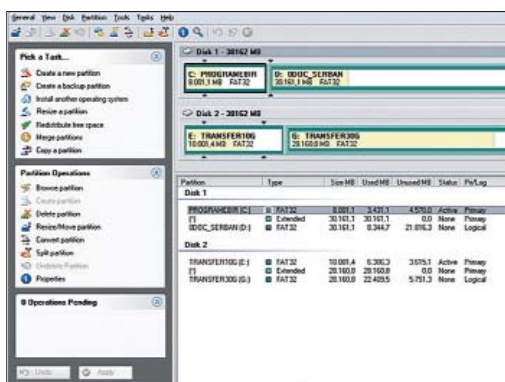
Sadananda Singha

A DVDs have nine region codes: Region 0 is region-free and such DVDs will play on all drives. Regions 7 is reserved and not set. Region 8 is for use on international planes, ships etc. These settings can be changed four times at most, after which they get locked to the last region used. It looks like you have changed the region more than four times, in which case you are out of luck. Remember, you do not have to change the region simply because you are in India. To play a DVD made in the US, for example, your player needs to be in Region 1.

You can bypass the region lock that each DVD player comes with using various software. However, this is illegal and will render your warranty void.

Get FAT!

Q My OS is Win98. I installed Win2000 Pro and it asked to upgrade with NTFS which I did. Now, I cannot format my C: drive on which my OS resides. When I try to format it, the D: drive gets formatted. My C: drive file system is NTFS and other drives, including the D: drive are FAT32. How can I change my C: drive from NTFS to FAT32?



Managing drives in Partition Magic 8.0

A Download a tool called PartitionMagic (<http://www.powerquest.com/partition-magic/>) that lets you convert from NTFS to FAT32 without losing your data. If possible, backup your data as a precaution.

Hey RAM!

Q The specs of my PC are as follows: Athlon XP 2400+, 256MB PC133 DDR RAM (Hynix) and a Krypton C18G-400 motherboard with onboard nVidia Geforce 4. Recently, my friend accidentally dropped my RAM module. But there were no cracks or scratches. From then on, while launching some applications or games, it shows an error—" (appname).exe has encountered a problem and needs to close." When I viewed the technical contents of this report, it displayed, "The following files will be included: D:\DOCUME~1\SIVASU~1\LOCALS~1\Temp\WER6.tmp.dir00\gta-vc.exe.mdmf. D:\DOCUME~1\SIVASU~1\LOCALS~1\Temp\WER6.tmp.dir00\appcompat.txt"

For each application, only the number after "WER" and the application name itself changes. It happens mostly when launching GTA:Vice City, Colin McRae Rally 2, Adobe Live Motion and PDF-to-HTML converter. Is it due to my Hynix RAM? Do I need to get it replaced (it is within the warranty period)? Are there any tools to detect damaged RAM modules?

M Siva Subramanian

A To test whether your RAM is damaged, remove all RAM modules from their slots and insert only one of them into a slot. Now run any the following utility: <http://www.memtest86.com/> Or get the Microsoft utility at: <http://oca.microsoft.com/en/windiag.asp>

If you get an error, run the test again with your RAM chip in a different slot. If you do not get an error this time, then your RAM slot is not faulty. Repeat the test for all the RAM chips you have.

It may turn out that both your RAM slots are faulty. To make sure that it is your RAM chip at fault, test it on another machine where the slots are working fine.

If you do not get any memory errors, then your RAM chip is fine and you should try reinstalling your games and software and updating them with the latest patches.

Internal HDD, External Connection

Q I have a P III 1.0 GHz, a Vesta 810e Intel chipset board with 256 MB of SDRAM and an 80 GB Seagate HDD running Win98 and WinXP as the OSes, a CD-ROM and an LG CD-RW. I also have a 40 GB Seagate HDD not connected to the system. The 40 GB HDD is divided into three partitions running Win98. The 80 GB HDD is divided into six partitions—four as FAT and two as NTFS. How can I connect my HDD to my system without opening the cabinet? Do I need any special drivers?

Ravi Shah